

SPREADSHEET FORMULA REFERENCE

Ten formulas cover almost every science fair calculation. They work the same in Excel and Google Sheets.

WHAT YOU WANT	TYPE THIS	WHAT IT DOES
Add up a column	<code>=SUM(B2:B10)</code>	Total of every value from B2 through B10
Average of your trials	<code>=AVERAGE(B2:B10)</code>	Your headline number for a condition
Largest value	<code>=MAX(B2:B10)</code>	Used with MIN to find the range
Smallest value	<code>=MIN(B2:B10)</code>	Used with MAX to find the range
Range	<code>=MAX(B2:B10) - MIN(B2:B10)</code>	How much your results varied
Count how many trials	<code>=COUNT(B2:B10)</code>	Counts cells that contain numbers
Average for one condition only	<code>=AVERAGEIF(A:A, "Control", B:B)</code>	Averages column B wherever column A says Control
Round to one decimal	<code>=ROUND(B2, 1)</code>	Keeps reported numbers tidy
Percent change	<code>=(B3-B2)/B2</code>	Format the cell as a percentage
Difference from the control	<code>=B3-\$B\$2</code>	The dollar signs keep B2 locked when you fill down

BOTH PROGRAMS WORK THE SAME WAY

Every formula above works identically in Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets. Type the equals sign first; without it the cell shows text instead of calculating.

MAKING A GRAPH

- Select your data including the header row.
- Excel: Insert, then Charts. Google Sheets: Insert, then Chart.
- Choose bar for comparing groups, line for change over time, scatter for two measured numbers.
- Add a title and axis labels with units before you print it.

READY-MADE VERSION

The FairGame Graph and Chart Templates workbook has these charts already built. Replace the sample data with yours and the chart updates itself.